Mgr. art. Mária Novotná PhD.
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Resumé

Researcher in architectural heritage, alpine architecture, and preservation of 20th-century modernism, with a specialization in mountain environments.

The work investigates how architecture adapts — or fails to adapt — to climate pressure, tourism expansion, and changing construction systems in fragile alpine regions. Through hybrid methods, I examine the transformation of mountain huts, ski infrastructure, and modernistic architectural heritage.

International research experience includes Fulbright research at the University of Colorado Denver and Laboratory of Alpine History at Università della Svizzera italiana in Mendrisio. My research has been presented internationally and published in peer-reviewed journals focused on architecture, preservation, and alpine studies.

Interests

- construction heritage
- preservation methodologies
- adaptive reuse
- climate adaptation
- alpine architecture
- modernism
- resilient architecture
- heritage transformation
- hiking, skiing, horse riding
- long distance driving
- city flaneuring
- reading, learning

Education

2020 – 2025: PhD in Architecture
FACULTY OF ARCHITECTURE AND DESIGN, SLOVAK TECHNICAL UNIVERSITY IN BRATISLAVA (FAD), SLOVAKIA
Institute of History and Theory of Architecture and Monument Restoration
Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Ing. arch. Henrieta Moravčíková
Dissertation:
Mountain Solitaires: Innovations in Mountain Architecture of the 20th Century in Slovakia

2010 – 2016: Master of Fine Arts – Architecture and Urbanism
ACADEMY OF FINE ARTS AND DESIGN (AFAD), BRATISLAVA, SLOVAKIA
Studios of: Petr Hájek and Vito Halada; Imro Vaško and Dominik Strzelec

INTERNATIONAL ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE
Bezalel Academy of Arts and Design, Jerusalem, Israel - studio of Liat Brix Etgar
CEPT University, Ahmedabad, India - studio of Nitin Raje

Research Experience

2024 – 2025: Fulbright Doctoral Student
COLLEGE OF ARCHITECTURE AND PLANNING, UNIVERSITY OF COLORADO DENVER, USA
Research on mountain architecture, climate-related transformation of alpine landscapes, and adaptive strategies for vulnerable recreational infrastructure. Conducted interdisciplinary research on temporary mountain settlements, tourism pressure, and resilient architectural responses within fragile environmental conditions.

2022 – 2025: Visiting Researcher
LABORATORY OF ALPINE HISTORY (LABISALP), ACADEMY OF ARCHITECTURE, UNIVERSITÀ DELLA SVIZZERA ITALIANA, MENDRISIO, SWITZERLAND
Comparative research on alpine architectural heritage, preservation discourse, and the evolution of mountain construction systems in the 20th century. Researched international approach concerning conservation methodologies, heritage assessment, and adaptive reuse of alpine structures and mountain huts.

2020 – 2025: Research Collaborator
HISTORICAL INSTITUTE, SLOVAK ACADEMY OF SCIENCES (SAV), SLOVAKIA
Collaboration on research projects examining postwar architectural heritage, innovation in architecture, and preservation of modern built environments. Contributed to interdisciplinary research activities, publication development, and heritage documentation initiatives.

Teaching & Academic Mentorship

2024 – 2025: Studio Assistant – Immersive Studio
COLLEGE OF ARCHITECTURE AND PLANNING CU DENVER, COLORADO
Held lecture, supported seminars, mentored students, student consultations and research-based teaching activities focused on landscape, heritage transformation, and spatial analysis.

2020 – 2024: Teaching Assistant – Current Trends in Architecture
FACULTY OF ARCHITECTURE AND DESIGN, SLOVAK TECHNICAL UNIVERSITY
Organized lectures, managed speakers, supported seminars, student consultations and evaluations, and edited 3 volumes of the annual publications.

2020 – 2021: Teaching Assistant – History of Modern Architecture
FACULTY OF ARCHITECTURE AND DESIGN, SLOVAK TECHNICAL UNIVERSITY
Assisted with lectures, tutorials, and student supervision related to modern architectural history, preservation discourse, and 20th-century architecture.

2021 – 2023: Lecturer – AutoCAD for Beginners
CREATIVE POINT, BRATISLAVA
Delivered technical tutorials in architectural drafting, digital workflows, and construction documentation.

Professional Practice & Research-base Design

2016 – Present: Architect & Freelancer
Architectural practice operating between research, heritage, landscape, and cultural analysis, with a focus on adaptive reuse, and contemporary interventions.

Work includes
- research-driven architectural competitions
- landscape and tourism-related spatial analysis
- preservation-oriented design strategies
- public exhibitions and interdisciplinary collaborations
- architectural interpretation of modern heritage sites

Selected Collaborations
- Matúš Antolík
- Rea Svitak
- Samo Netočný
- Office N/A
- Projekt A01

Research Funding & Grants

2024: Fulbright Scholarship, United States
Competitive international research fellowship supporting research on alpine architecture, climate exposure, and preservation challenges in mountain environments.

2022: SAIA National Scholarship Programme, Switzerland
Research mobility grant supporting collaboration with the Laboratory of Alpine History (LabisAlp), Università della Svizzera italiana, Mendrisio.

2020: Young Researcher Grant, Slovak Technical University
Institutional research funding supporting doctoral research on innovations in mountain architecture and architectural heritage of the 20th century.

2019: Extraordinary Challenge Grant, Slovak Arts Council (FPÚ)
Research and cultural funding supporting interdisciplinary architectural research and public engagement activities.

Research Project Participation

Contributor and collaborating researcher within nationally funded VEGA research projects, international Norwegian Grants and European structure Interreg focused on:
- heritage values of 20th century architecture
- innovation in architecture
- preservation and interpretation of modern architectural heritage

Selected projects:
- Heritage Values of Architecture from the Second Half of the 20th Century (2024–2027)
- Innovation in Architecture (2020–2023)
- Projekt Tatry (2021–ongoing)
- Interreg: Art Nouveau II (2020–2022)
- Reflections on Architecture (2020–2023)

Selected Academic Activities & Conferences

2026

REGIONAL MOUNTAIN CONFERENCE, OBERGURGL, AUSTRIA - JULY 2026
Contributions:

- The Future of Ski Resorts on the Last Snow – Temporary Mountain Settlements, Climate Exposure and Spatial Conflict
- Lessons from Alpine Huts: The Evolution of Resilient Architecture in Fragile Mountain Landscapes

DIRECTOR & ORGANIZER: MODERNISM REVISITED 2026 CONFERENCE, TRENČÍN, SK
European Capital of Culture Trenčín 2026
ETOM Milestone Conference 2026
Under the auspices of DOCOMOMO International and the Slovak Chamber of Architects

2025

ETOM PILOT CONFERENCE, BERLIN
Contribution:

- Shared Landscapes: Modern Neighborhoods as Urban and Architectural Intervention within Fragile Environments

LECTURER – MOUNTAIN ARCHITECTURE
College of Architecture and Planning, Denver

DIRECTOR & ORGANIZER
Modernism Revisited Colloquium 2025 & Conference 2026
Reflecting on Modernistic Architectural Legacy
European Capital of Culture Trenčín 2026

2024

PUBLIC DISCUSSION ON BOOK: REPORT ON SLOVAK ARCHITECTURE
Christiania, Poprad, SK

2023

COLLOQUIUM – INNOVATIONS IN 20TH CENTURY ARCHITECTURE IN SLOVAKIA
Contribution: *Steel prefabrication and the Mountains*

CONFERENCE – POINT FOR SCIENCE 4
Contribution: *Mountain Solitaires in the Demänovská Valley*

2022

LECTURER – ALPINE HUTS IN HIGH TATRAS
Academy of Architecture, Mendrisio

CONFERENCE – POINT FOR SCIENCE 3
Contribution: *Architecture of the Mountain Cottage, Téryho Chata*

EXHIBITION ARCHITECT & CURATOR – COOL NOUVEAU
Umelka Gallery, Bratislava

Competitions with office N/A

Second Prize – 2023
Visitor Center of the Demänovská Caves and NAPANT

First Prize – 2018
Renovation of Mierové and Kláštorné Square in Malacky

Honourable Mention – 2018
New Swimming Pool in Ružomberok

Second Prize – 2017
New Park in Leopoldov

Selected Peer-Reviewed Publications

2025

THE TAMING OF THE WILD

The Taming of the Wild. In: *Mountain Studies*, Fabrica Litterarum Polono-Italica, 2(10), s.1–12. DOI: 10.31261/FLPI.2025.10.16

Research on tourism pressure, environmental transformation, and architecture in vulnerable mountain landscapes.

2023

TATRAS PHOENIX

Tatras Phoenix: Architecture of restoration in the alpine environment of the High Tatras. In: *ArchAlp: International journal of alpine architecture and landscape*. Torino: Istituto di Architettura Montana – IAM

DOI: 10.30682/aa2310r

Study of restoration strategies and resilient architecture in alpine environments.

ALPINE HUTS

Alpine huts: Architectural innovations and development in the High Tatras in the second half of the 20th century. In: *Alfa: architecture papers of the Faculty of architecture and design STU*. Bratislava: STU in Bratislava. FAD, 2023, 28(**1**), p. 47-55. ISSN 2729-7640.

DOI 10.2478/alfa-2023-0005

Historical analysis of mountain huts in Western Carpathian.

2022

TÉRY HUT

The Mountain Lodge Téry Hut: Innovations in Alpine-Zone Architecture. In: *Architektúra & urbanizmus: časopis pre teóriu architektúry a urbanizmu*. Bratislava: Slovak academy of science. 2022, 56(**1-2**), p. 116-125. ISSN 0044-8680.

DOI 10.31577/archandurb.2022.56.1-2.10

Analysis of pioneering modernism in the mountains.

2021

SLAVES TO PREFABRICATION

Slaves to prefabrication. In: Autoportret: pismo o dobrej przestrzeni: kwartalnik Małopolskiego Instytutu Kultury. Krakov: Malopolski Instytut Kultury, 2021, 72(**1**), p. 110-113. ISSN 1730-3613.

Study of post-war mass housing development in Bratislava.

Memberships

- DOCOMOMO Slovakia Working Group
- Alpenverein (Austrian Alpine Club)
- PreDolinu NGO
- KST – Slovak Hiking Association

Research Methods

- architectural heritage assessment
- preservation methodologies
- field documentation and archival research
- spatial and landscape analysis
- adaptive reuse analysis
- interdisciplinary research methods
- construction history research
- architectural surveying and visual documentation

Digital & Fabrication Tools

AutoCAD
ArchiCAD
Rhinoceros 3D
Grasshopper
SketchUp
Adobe Photoshop
Adobe Illustrator
Adobe InDesign
Affinity Suite
3D printing
laser cutting
CNC fabrication
physical model prototyping

Languages

Slovak — Native
English — Full professional proficiency (TOEFL 92)
Czech — Professional proficiency
German — Basic - currently improving

Field Experience

Extensive field research experience in alpine and remote mountain environments, including architectural documentation, landscape observation, and heritage analysis in climate-sensitive regions all year round in every weather.